STUDIO VALENTINA

THE ARCHITECT'S SOFTWARE STACK

Free Guide · Which program, for what, and when

Revit, Rhino, SketchUp, AutoCAD, Enscape — a working order instead of a tutorial list.
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From the Built Intelligence newsletter · studio-valentina.com

01 THE MAP

Pick the tool for the decision you are making.

01

Revit

Documentation and coordination. One model, every sheet. Use it the moment the project must be built, not before.

BIM · PERMIT SET

02

Rhino + Grasshopper

Geometry that Revit resists: curved facades, panelization, repeated studies driven by parameters.

FORM · STUDIES

03

SketchUp

Thinking in volume, fast, in front of the client. Perfect for the first week — never for the permit set.

CONCEPT · SPEED

04

AutoCAD

Still the language of surveys, consultants and many building departments. Know how to clean and link an external DWG.

2D · EXCHANGE

05

Enscape / Twinmotion

Real-time render straight from the model. Use it as a design check every week, not as a final deliverable only.

RENDER · VR

06

Bluebeam + Canva

Markups, takeoffs and sets that consultants can comment on — then boards and proposals the client enjoys reading.

REVIEW · PRESENTATION

02 LEARNING ORDER

Learn them in this order. Not all at once.

01

SketchUp — 10 h

Volume, scale and section cuts. You should be able to model a house in an afternoon.

02

Revit — 60 h

Levels, families, views, sheets, schedules. Documentation first, fancy families later.

03

Enscape — 6 h

Materials, sun study, one good camera. Render weekly to catch design mistakes early.

04

AutoCAD — 12 h

Only what you need: xrefs, layers, plotting, cleaning a surveyor's file.

05

Rhino — 40 h

When geometry starts fighting you. Grasshopper after, not before.

A portfolio does not improve because you listed nine programs. It improves because one project is fully resolved in two of them.

03 FILE DISCIPLINE

The habits that keep a project from collapsing.

01

Naming

- [ ] **PROJECT_DISCIPLINE_SHEET_YYMMDD**

—
date
last,
always

- [ ] No "final", "final2", "final_good" — the date is the version
- [ ] Same folder tree on every project, from day one
- [ ] One current folder, one archive folder, nothing loose on the desktop

02

Models

- [ ] Origin to origin on every link — set it once, at the start
- [ ] Levels and grids are owned by one model only
- [ ] Purge unused and audit before every delivery
- [ ] Three backups: local, cloud, and one you can reach without internet

DELIVERABLE	NATIVE	SEND AS
Permit set	Revit	PDF, flattened, with a sheet index
Consultant coordination	Revit / IFC	IFC or linked RVT + a PDF of the same date
Client presentation	Enscape + Canva	PDF landscape, under 20 MB

04 REVIT

Eight habits that save a week per project.

01 Set up once

- [ ] Build a template with your titleblock, text, dimensions and view types
- [ ] Name views so the browser sorts itself:

A-
PLAN-
01-
FLOOR

- [ ] View templates for every drawing type — never adjust a view by hand twice
- [ ] Scope boxes before you start placing sheets

02 Work clean

- [ ] Schedules instead of counting by hand — they update, you don't
- [ ] Model what you will draw; don't model screws
- [ ] Warnings reviewed weekly, not the night before delivery
- [ ] Keep a shared parameters file and never rename parameters mid-project

NEXT STEPS

Keep going.

01

AI for Architects

The companion playbook: where AI helps in a real project. Free at studio-valentina.com/resources.

02

Built Intelligence

The newsletter on LinkedIn: AI, BIM and architecture, every edition.

03

Work together

Architecture and interior design for custom homes in Georgia.



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General information only. Software names belong to their owners and are referenced for identification only. Times shown are typical for a small residential project and will vary with scope and team.